Dinosaur Poster

U02 / S02.3

NAME _____ DATE _____ PERIOD _____

THE JOB

Make a colored infographic poster about one Mesozoic dinosaur: pictures, a map, and short labels, not paragraphs.

POSTER OUTLINE

NAME HEADER your dinosaur's name, big

MESOZOIC TIMELINE mark when your dinosaur lived (mya means million years ago)

TRIASSIC 252 to 201 mya	JURASSIC 201 to 145 mya	CRETACEOUS 145 to 66 mya

DRAWING
your dinosaur, big. Tracing is fine.

ABOUT MY DINOSAUR
period · hip type · diet · habitat · walks on · size · special feature · fossils found in

MAP OF EARTH BACK THEN
continents where they were, with a dot on each fossil site

● fossil site

Solid teal border: facts. Dashed black border: pictures. Where the zones sit is up to you.

WHAT YOUR POSTER NEEDS

1. **Name header.** Big enough to read across the room.
2. **Mesozoic timeline.** All three periods with their dates. Mark when your dinosaur lived.
3. **Drawing.** Big. Tracing is fine.
4. **About My Dinosaur.** One answer for each fact in the table below.
5. **Map.** Earth when your dinosaur lived, not today's map. A dot on every fossil site, and a key for the dots.
6. **Color.** The whole poster, not pencil or pen alone.

FACT	WHAT TO PUT
Period	Early, Middle, or Late, plus Triassic, Jurassic, or Cretaceous. For example, Late Jurassic.
Hip type	**Lizard-hipped (saurischian):** in most of them, the pubis hip bone points forward, like a lizard's. *T. rex*, *Velociraptor*, and the long-necked plant-eaters are in this group. **Bird-hipped (ornithischian):** the pubis points backward, like a bird's. All of them ate plants, like *Stegosaurus* and *Triceratops*. The names are backwards from what you'd guess: birds come from the lizard-hipped group.
Diet	carnivore (meat), herbivore (plants), omnivore (both), or fish-eater
Habitat	forest, river floodplain, coastal plain, swamp or wetland, desert dunes, or open woodland
Walks on	2 legs, 4 legs, or both
Size	length in meters, next to a school bus (about 12 m). A 24 m dinosaur is about 2 buses long.
Special feature	horns, frill, armor, plates or spikes, claws, crest, feathers, speed, or size
Fossils found in	every country or state where its fossils have been found, not just one. Each one becomes a dot on your map.

Pick any Mesozoic dinosaur and look up its facts. Pterosaurs, plesiosaurs, ichthyosaurs, and mosasaurs don't count.

My Plan and Rubric

MY PLAN

Fill this in before you start.

My dinosaur _____

Period _____

Hip type _____

Fossils found in (every country or state) _____

Where I got my facts and picture (website or book) _____

RUBRIC · 20 POINTS

PART	FULL CREDIT	PARTIAL	LITTLE OR NONE	SCORE
Name header 2 points	2. Dinosaur's name across the top, spelled right and big enough to read from across the room.	1. Name is there but small or misspelled.	0. No name.	☐
Timeline 3 points	3. Triassic, Jurassic, and Cretaceous with their dates. When your dinosaur lived is marked in the right period.	1 to 2. A period or its dates are missing, or the mark is in the wrong place.	0. No timeline.	☐
Drawing 3 points	3. A big, clear drawing of your dinosaur. Tracing is fine.	1 to 2. Small, unfinished, or hard to tell what it is.	0. No drawing.	☐
About My Dinosaur 5 points	5. All 8 facts, and they're correct: period, hip type, diet, habitat, walks on, size compared with a school bus, special feature, fossils found in.	2 to 4. Some facts are missing or wrong.	0 to 1. One or two facts, or none.	☐
Map & fossil dots 4 points	4. Earth when your dinosaur lived, not today's map. A dot on each place its fossils were found, and a key for the dots.	2 to 3. Today's map, or dots missing or in the wrong places.	0 to 1. No map, or a map with no dots.	☐
Clear, visual, color 3 points	3. Pictures and short labels, no paragraphs. The whole poster is colored and readable from a few feet away.	1 to 2. Too much writing, or only parts are colored.	0. Mostly paragraphs, or mostly black and white.	☐

TOTAL ☐ **/ 20**